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# Prompting and assisting with medication in Home Care

## Why may a person need assistance?

[2-minutes]

As a person ages they may encounter problems that make fully managing their medication more difficult, with help prompting or assisting with medication we can ensure individuals retain their independence.

- 9 - Documentation and record keeping
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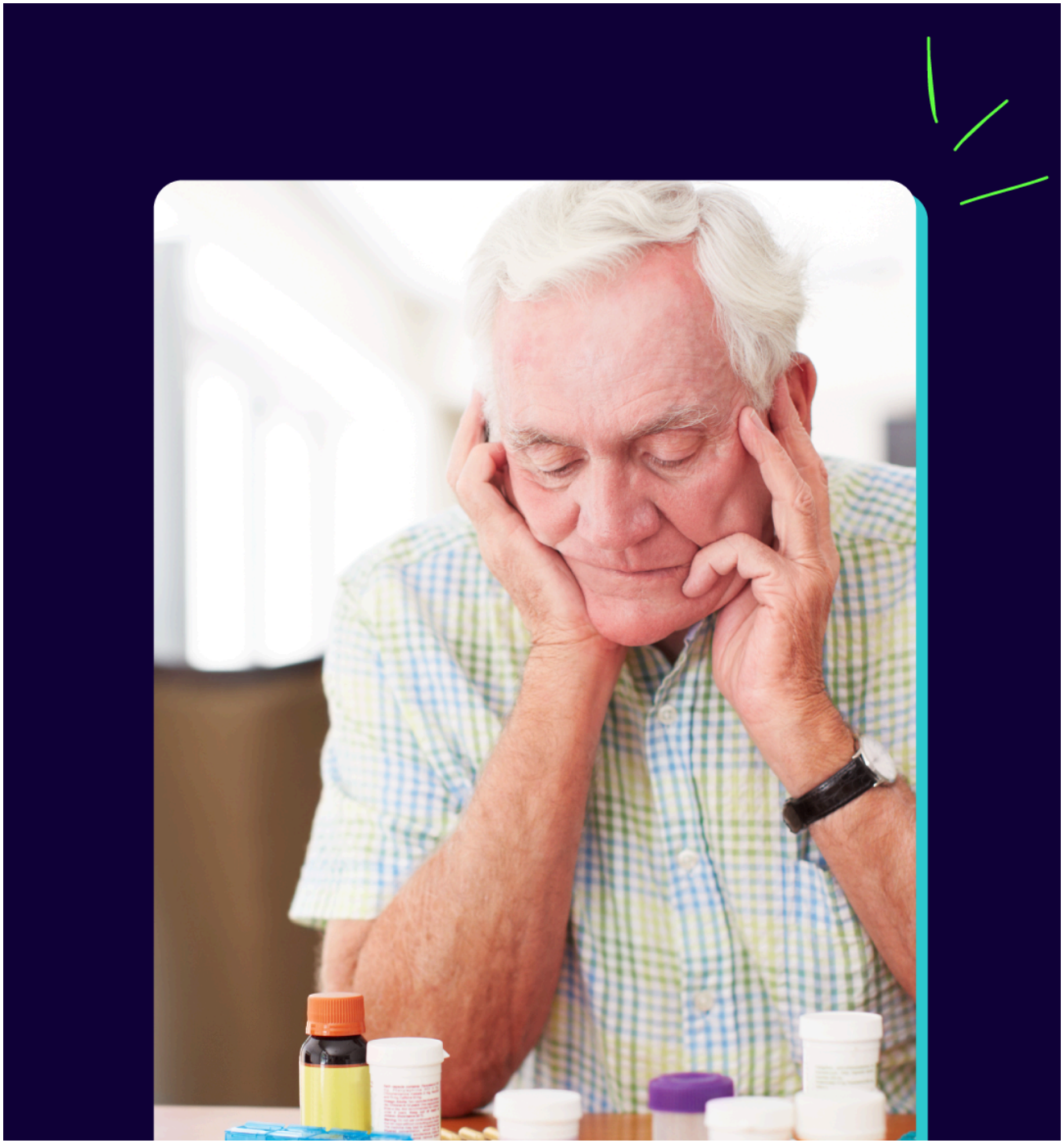


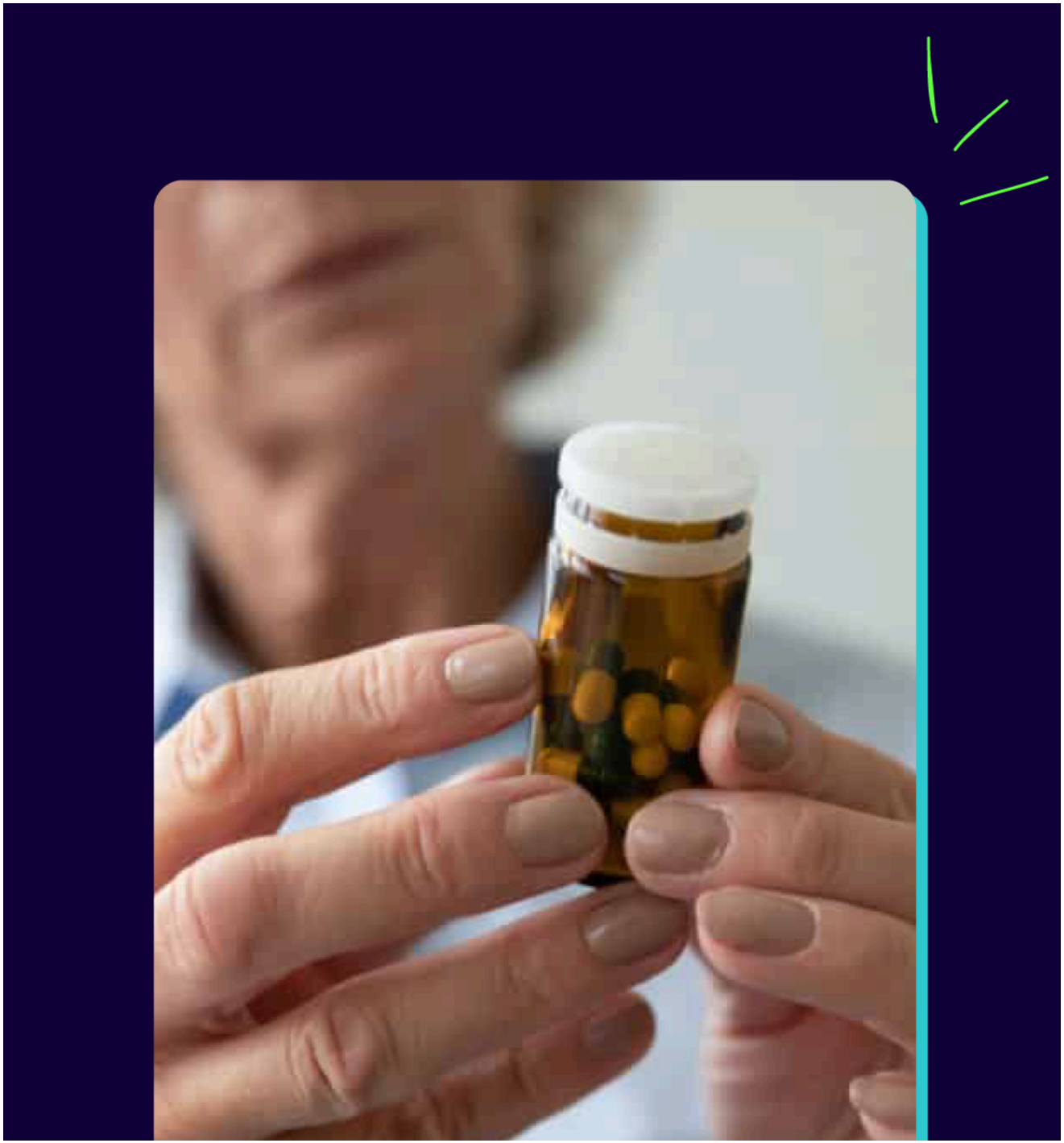
'Self administration' is when a person can take their own medicines.

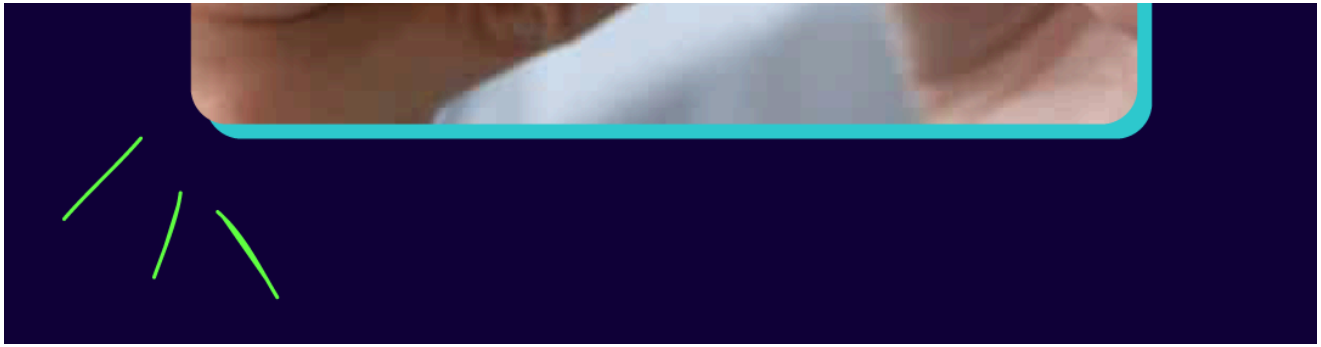
People have the right to choose to manage their own medicines. Care professionals should always support service users with their medication in a way that maximises independence and choice. If there is a risk of harm to themselves or others in regards to medication, this should be included in a risk assessment and care plan.

## Common challenges to taking medication

There can be some simple reasons as to why people need help to take their medicine.

- Service user can’t collect medicines
- Service user forgetting to take / getting mixed up
- Difficulty reading labels
- Difficulty opening bottles
- Can’t pop the blister pack
- Too many medicines kept





💡 *Care professionals should always look to help service users retain their independence. This means doing all we can to help them to 'self administer' medication.*

## What is self-administration?

- ◯ When a person can take their own medicines
- ◯ When a person cannot take their own medicines
- ◯ When a doctor administers medicines to a service user
- ◯ When a nurse administers medicines to a service user

Check your answer

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